



Momentum Digital

Custom software, digital growth, and ownership-first development

PHASE 2 DOCUMENTATION

Software Environment, Tools & Core Setup

VA Claims — Custom Software Platform (working name: Amelia)

Phase 2 setup guide and technical requirements for the development team.

CLIENT	VA Claims	AGENCY	Momentum Digital
PHASE	2 of 5	PREPARED	June 2026
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Operationalizes Phase 2 of the VA Claims Custom Software Development & Ownership Agreement (Momentum Digital, May 2026).

SECTION 1

Phase 2 at a Glance

Phase 2 follows the approved Phase 1 discovery and roadmap. Its purpose is to stand up the technical foundation that all core development in Phase 3 will be built on. This document translates the Phase 2 scope from the Custom Software Development & Ownership Agreement into concrete setup tasks, recommendations, deliverables, and exit criteria for the build team.

Phase 2 scope (per the agreement)

- Development environment setup
- Software framework setup
- User access and permissions planning
- Database or backend structure setup
- Tool and platform configuration
- Secure access setup where applicable

Objectives

- 1 Stand up reproducible local, staging, and production environments.
- 2 Select and scaffold the application framework agreed in Phase 1.
- 3 Define the user role and permission model before features are built.
- 4 Establish the database / backend schema foundation — including the structures the Phase 3 “Payment Watch” feature will depend on.
- 5 Configure supporting tools and platforms (version control, CI, hosting, monitoring, communication).
- 6 Implement a secure access baseline (secrets management, authentication, least-privilege).

Approval gate

Phase 2 begins after Phase 1 approval and the \$3,000 Phase 2 prepayment. Phase 3 begins only after Phase 2 is reviewed and approved by VA Claims and the next prepayment is completed.

Out of scope for Phase 2

Core feature development, the Payment Watch tracking logic and UI, third-party integrations, and user dashboards are Phase 3 work. Phase 2 prepares the ground; it does not build features.

SECTION 2

Detailed Setup Requirements

2.1 Development Environment Setup

Goal

A reproducible environment any developer can run locally, plus separate staging and production environments.

Key tasks

- Local dev setup documentation (“clone → install → run”).
- Environment variable templates (**.env.example**).
- Pinned dependency and runtime versions.
- Optional containerization (e.g., Docker) for parity.
- Clear separation of dev / staging / production.

Deliverables

- Environment README.
- **.env.example** file.
- The application skeleton running locally on each developer machine.
- A provisioned staging environment.

2.2 Software Framework Setup

Goal

Select and scaffold the application stack decided in Phase 1, with conventions in place before feature work begins.

Key tasks

- Confirm frontend and backend frameworks.
- Scaffold the project and folder structure.
- Configure linting and formatting.
- Set up base routing and a health-check endpoint.
- Establish coding standards.

Recommendation (starter — confirm against Phase 1 decisions)

A modern, ownership-friendly web stack such as a React/Next.js frontend with a TypeScript/Node or Python backend and a PostgreSQL relational database. Favor mainstream, well-documented tooling so VA Claims can maintain and own the codebase after handoff.

Deliverables

- Scaffolded repository that builds and runs.
- Coding-standards note.
- Base application shell.

2.3 User Access & Permissions Planning

Goal

Define who can do what in the platform before features are built.

Key tasks

- Enumerate user roles (e.g., Admin, Staff / Claims Agent — confirm the full list with VA Claims).
- Map permissions to each role.
- Choose an authentication method (email/password and/or SSO).
- Set session and timeout policy.
- Plan audit logging for access to sensitive records.

Note

VA claims involve sensitive veteran PII. Design for least-privilege access and audit logging from the start.

Deliverables

- A roles-and-permissions matrix.
- Documented authentication approach.

2.4 Database / Backend Structure Setup

Goal

Establish the foundational data model and backend structure.

Key tasks

- Model core entities (Clients/Veterans, Claims, C&P exam events, Users).

- Set up a migrations tool.
- Create seed / test data.
- Define a backup strategy.

Preparing for Phase 3: Payment Watch

The Phase 3 Payment Watch feature monitors clients 60–120 days and 121+ days post C&P exam, with manual timer initiation, a two-group dashboard view, and paid-status management. Design the client/record schema now to support it — for example fields such as **cp_exam_date**, **watch_timer_started_at**, a derived **watch_group** (60–120 vs 121+), **paid_status**, and **paid_at**. Build only the schema foundation in Phase 2; the tracking logic and dashboard are built in Phase 3.

Deliverables

- Initial schema and migrations applied to staging.
- An entity-relationship diagram (ERD).
- Seed data.

2.5 Tool & Platform Configuration

Goal

Stand up the development and operations tooling that supports the build.

Key tasks

- Version control (Git repository + branching strategy).
- A CI pipeline (lint, test, build).
- A hosting / deploy target for staging.
- Error monitoring and logging.
- Project-management and communication channels per the agreement.

Deliverables

- Repository with green CI.
- Staging auto-deploy on merge.
- Monitoring / logging connected.

2.6 Secure Access Setup

Goal

Establish a security baseline appropriate for sensitive veteran data.

Key tasks

- Secrets management (no secrets committed to the repo).
- HTTPS/TLS everywhere.
- Role-based access to infrastructure.
- Least-privilege cloud IAM.
- Dependency vulnerability scanning.
- A validated backup/restore.
- A basic data-handling note aligned with the agreement's confidentiality and ownership terms.

Deliverables

- Configured secrets store.
- Documented access controls.
- A security checklist.

SECTION 3

Phase 2 Definition of Done (Exit Criteria)

Phase 2 is complete and ready for client approval when:

- ☐ Local, staging, and production environments are running and documented.
- ☐ The application framework is scaffolded, builds cleanly, and follows agreed conventions.
- ☐ The roles-and-permissions matrix is documented and approved.
- ☐ The foundational database schema is migrated on staging (including fields that support the Phase 3 Payment Watch feature).
- ☐ The repository has green CI and staging deploys automatically.
- ☐ The secrets-management and security baseline are in place.
- ☐ A Phase 2 walkthrough/demo has been delivered to VA Claims and approved.

Unlocks Phase 3

Client approval of Phase 2, together with the Phase 3 prepayment, unlocks Phase 3 (Core Development & Feature Buildout).

SECTION 4

Assumptions, Dependencies & Open Questions

Assumptions

- Phase 1 discovery decisions (technology stack, hosting, user roles) are finalized and carried forward into this document.

Dependencies

- VA Claims to confirm the full list of user roles.
- Provide any required third-party or API access.
- Approve the hosting provider.

Open questions

- Confirm the final technology stack.
- Confirm the hosting provider.
- Confirm the complete list of user roles.
- Confirm data-retention and compliance requirements for veteran PII.

Reference

This document operationalizes Phase 2 of the VA Claims Custom Software Development & Ownership Agreement (Momentum Digital, May 2026). All ownership, confidentiality, and non-resale terms in that agreement apply.